THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE TEMPLATE

The First Build

A seven day template for turning the idea you keep carrying into a first version that exists.

Trust it, then tie your camel.

An idea that waits is an idea that dies.

Most people do not lack ideas. They lack a first version, something real enough to show, test and improve.

A well known saying of the Prophet, peace be upon him, answers the man who asked whether to tie his camel or trust in God: tie it, then trust. Trust is not waiting. It is doing the part in front of you and leaving the outcome to God. For an idea, the part in front of you is small: a first version.

Waiting

Keep it in your head. Wait until you feel ready, funded, certain. Tell yourself you will start soon.

Building

Shrink it to one promise. Make a rough version in a week. Show it to real people and listen.

AI is the fastest way to close the gap between the thought and the first draft, because it does the slow parts: the outline, the copy, the first mock-up, the list of questions. You decide, and it drafts.

Seven days. One idea. One first version.

Get it out, make it small, name the person.

DAY 1	**Say the idea out loud.** Talk for three minutes into an AI, messy and unedited. Then ask for the idea back in one sentence you could say to a friend.
DAY 2	**Shrink it to one promise.** Not the whole vision. The one thing the first version must do, for one kind of person.
DAY 3	**Name the person.** Describe the one real human who would want this most. Write down where you could reach five people like them.

1 THE IDEA BACK

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I am going to describe a business idea out loud and it will be messy.
Do not improve it yet. Give it back to me as: one sentence a friend
would understand, the one person it is for, the problem it solves for
them, and the three biggest things I have not yet decided. Then wait.
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2 THE ONE PROMISE

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Here is my idea: (paste it). Reduce it to a single promise a first
version must keep, for one kind of customer. List what to leave out
of version one, and why. Keep the whole answer under 150 words.
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Make the rough thing.

The first build should embarrass you a little. If it does not, you waited too long.

DAY 4

Draft it. A one-page description, a simple page, a menu, a sample, a demo script. Whatever lets a person understand the promise in thirty seconds.

DAY 5

Make it presentable. Fix the words, the look and the first impression. Stop at good enough to show.

3 THE FIRST DRAFT

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Based on this promise: (paste it), write the simplest first version a
stranger could understand in thirty seconds. Give me the headline,
three lines on what it does and who it is for, and one clear next
step for the reader. Plain words, no hype, nothing I cannot actually
deliver.
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4 THE HONEST CRITIC

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Read this first version: (paste it). Tell me the three weakest
points, what a sceptical customer would ask first, and the one change
that would improve it most. Be direct. Do not praise it.
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Only promise what you can really deliver. A smaller honest first version beats a bigger one you cannot keep.

Show it. Listen. Decide.

DAY 6

Show it to five people. The people from Day 3. Send it, or show it on a call. Ask one question only: would you use this, and what is missing?

DAY 7

Read the pattern. Look at what they said, not what you hoped. Decide: improve it, change it, or take the next step.

5 THE FIVE QUESTIONS

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I am showing my first version to five people. Write a short, friendly
message to send with it, and three questions that find out what they
would really do, not what they think I want to hear. Avoid leading
questions.
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6 THE PATTERN

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Here is what five people said: (paste it). Group the answers into
themes, tell me what was said by more than one person, and what only
one person said. Recommend one of three next steps: improve it,
change it, or move forward, with one reason.
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Do not paste private customer details into any AI tool. Use first names or initials only, or none at all.

For the voice that says you cannot.

Doubt will arrive on Day 2 or Day 6. Expect it, and have a reply ready.

1 **Name the doubt in one sentence.** Not a feeling, a sentence. "I am not qualified." "I have no money." "Someone has done it."

2 **Ask what the smallest next step is anyway.** Doubt answers the whole mountain. You only need the next step.

3 **Do that step, then pray, rest and trust.** The effort is yours, the result is not.

7 THE DOUBT REPLY

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My doubt is: (one sentence). Do not reassure me. Tell me whether this
doubt is a real risk I should plan for or just fear, and give me the
smallest action I can take today that either answers it or moves past
it.
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If you do the seven days, you will have something most people never have: a real first version, in front of real people, with real feedback. That is not a guarantee of success. It is the honest beginning of it.

A working template to adapt, not financial or business advice. Results depend on you, your market and many things outside your control.

Tie your camel, then trust.